

settle a strike. He said he would use the Army to do it. As a matter of fact, most of the things that Theodore Roosevelt wanted to do were good for the country; but some of his schemes were dangerous.

However, his antagonism to railroads and railroad financiers was intense; that antagonism extended to practically all of the very large corporations. Even without his enmity, the railroads would have been having a hard time. Their facilities were unequal to the task of moving the freight on the first continent ever to have a single nation spread clear across it. James J. Hill had shocked the country by declaring that twelve and a half billion dollars would have to be spent within ten years if the railroads were to be put in shape to do the work that was demanded of them. Industries quite generally found themselves in unsatisfactory position, and so were dismissing many of their employees. At the same time all of the unemployed were finding themselves in competition for such jobs as there were, with myriads of immigrants. In the ten months ending in October, 1,150,000 strangers had reached our shores, and all had come to seek their fortunes in America. In the very month that the panic began, 111,000 immigrants were landed. In view of what was happening, that one fact represented a ghastly piece of bad management on the part of the Government. But this was not all: the copper industry had received a severe shock—a drop in the price of copper. In six months copper had declined from twenty-six cents to twelve cents a pound. Amalgamated Copper cut its dividend in half, and certain speculators in the stocks of copper companies found themselves in a financial vise.

The Knickerbocker Trust Company had been financing some of those copper speculations. It had improperly loaned some of its money to Charles W. Morse; something for which John T. Barney, the president, was held responsible later. This, of course, was a hidden weakness in the structure. What started a fatal run on the Knickerbocker Trust was an entirely different matter.